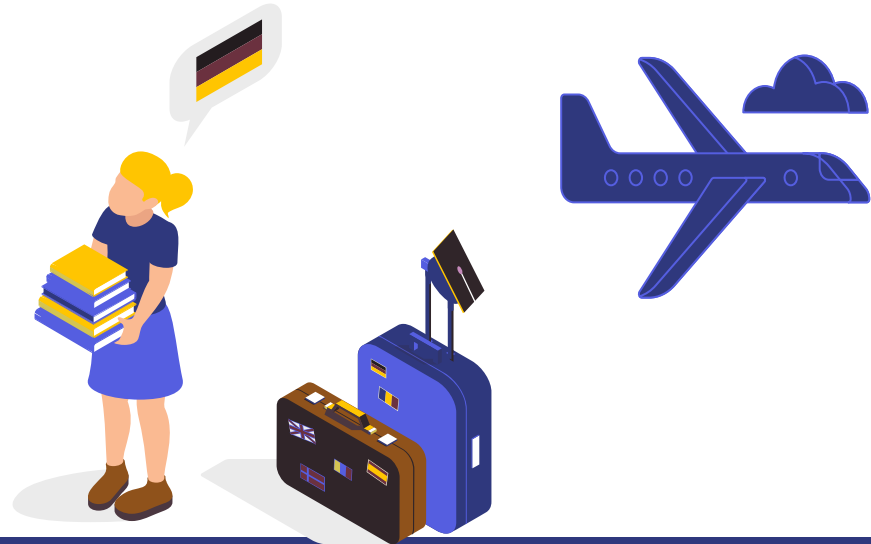


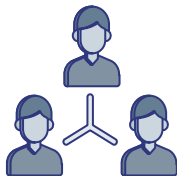
TravelJAM

By: Adam Kulikowski, Arya Bhanushali, Justin Lee, Meera Dave



Problem

Planning a trip or short term travel can be an overwhelming experience. The various options and logistics can make it challenging to find activities that align with one's interests, budgets, and time constraints.



Interests

Balancing varying desires of sightseeing and activities requires compromises, often resulting in dissatisfaction among group members.



Budgets

Balancing everyone's budgetary constraints while trying to ensure a fulfilling experience for all can be challenging and stress-inducing.



Time Constraints

Coordinating everyone's commitments, such as school, work, and personal obligations, can be challenging and may limit the group's ability to travel together.

TravelJAM Solution

User: Study abroad students

Experience: Technologically proficient

This project focuses on developing a personalized travel recommendation system tailored for students in study abroad programs. Our goal is to create an interface that customizes a travel plan based on the students' interests to enhance their travel experiences within their budget and time limits.



Interests

With a join group setting, each member is able to share their selected interest and activity with others, increasing collaboration and efficiency.



Budgets

Adjusting the budget will change the feed to only include appropriate activities that match the given limit.



Time Constraints

With a feed that prioritizes activities in the correct location and budget, time is not wasted looking at activities that are not feasible.

4 Phase Design Life Cycle

01

Needfinding

- Participant Observation
- Interviews

02

Design Alternatives

- Brainstorming session
- 3 low-fidelity prototypes

03

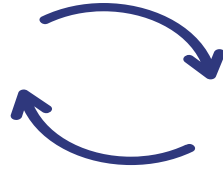
Prototyping

- Developed high-fidelity wireframe prototype

04

Evaluation

- Think-aloud



01 Which needfinding tactic?

Natural Observation-wrong environment



Surveys-lack of detail



Interview-informative 1:1



Participant Observation-group dynamic



Focus Groups-lack of depth



Think-aloud- testing usability



Participant Observation

Participants: Study abroad students

Pavan, Cooper, Cruz

Step 1

Ask for permission to sit in
on their planning

Step 2

Watch study abroad
students plan a trip

Step 3

Gather data on how
students conduct the
research

Step 4

Avoid bias throughout
the observation

Participant Observation Results

- Members double check bookings and ensure group stays together
- Majority of time was devoted to discussing location, comfort, and pricing
- Half group prioritized spending money to be close to main attractions while others were willing to get cheaper accommodation and spend on transportation
- Planning a trip is not an easy task and can often take multiple planning sessions to get everything figured out

Interview

Participants: Study abroad students

Spencer, Ritika, Ananya, Alexandra, Brant, Jack, Emre, Jefferey, Sagarika

Step 3

Ask extensive questions to help participants recall details, avoiding recall bias.

Step 1

Create list of questions regarding general travel experiences

Step 4

Conducted numerous interviews to gather a wide range of data.

Step 2

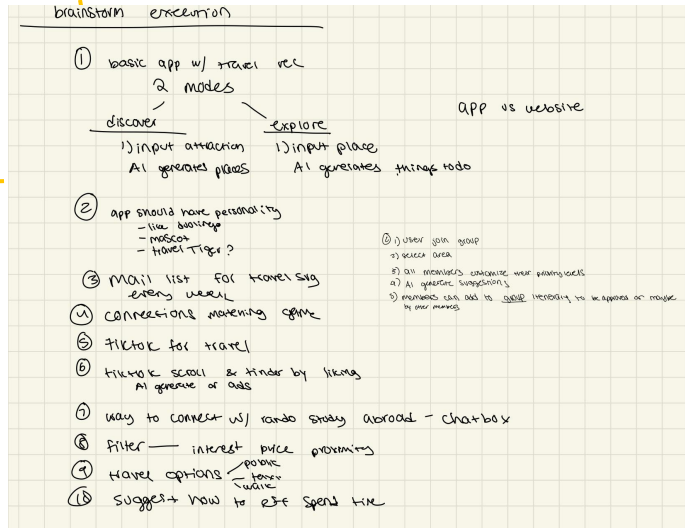
Use predetermined questions to prevent interviewer confirmation bias.

- Social desirability: conscious of our delivery
- Voluntary response: ensure participants have chance to speak

Interview Results

- Participants expressed the difficulties of conforming to everyone's budget and desired activities when planning a trip
- Most people spend several hours planning, striving to balance physical activities, cultural experiences, and affordability
- Average budget range was \$20-\$50 per activity
- Recurring theme of the difficulty of organizing transportation from one place to the other

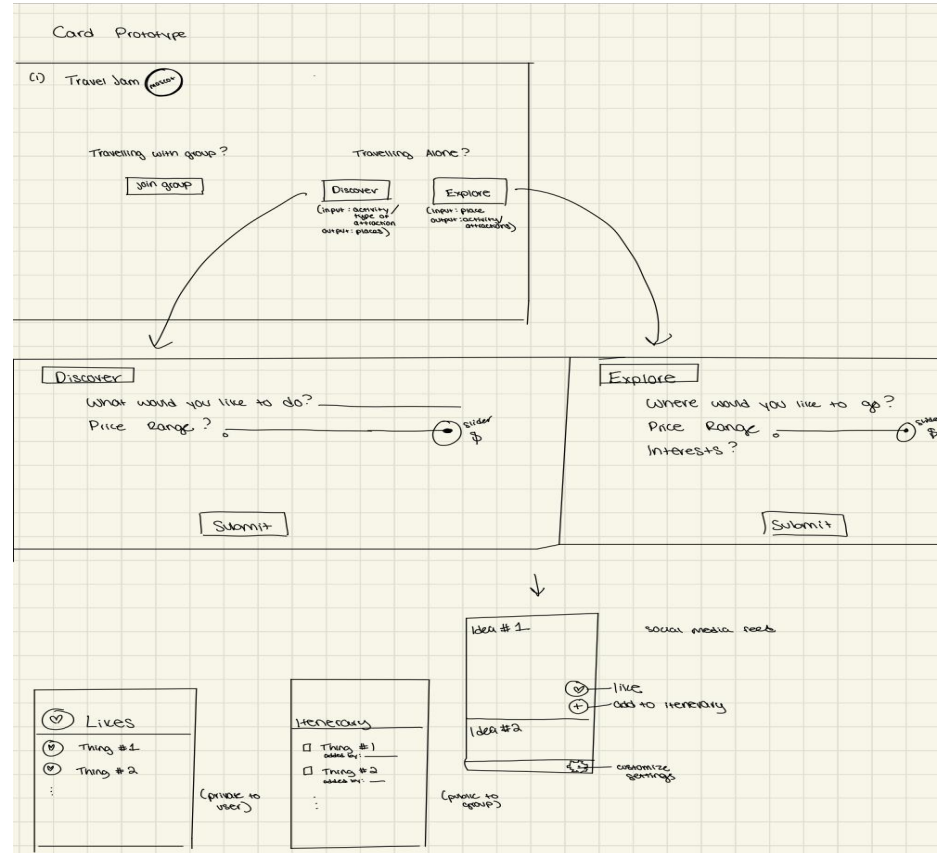
02 Brainstorming



- 30-40 minute individual brainstorm session employed under the rules of not talking over others, short explanations, sharing all ideas, staying on topic, and no comments initially
- Ideas fabricated about features we could we could add to our interface, others were decisions we had to make regarding the interface(app vs website). By the end of the brainstorming session we had made decisions on the format of our interface and the features we would like to incorporate.

02 Brainstorming

Prototype 1: Card prototype



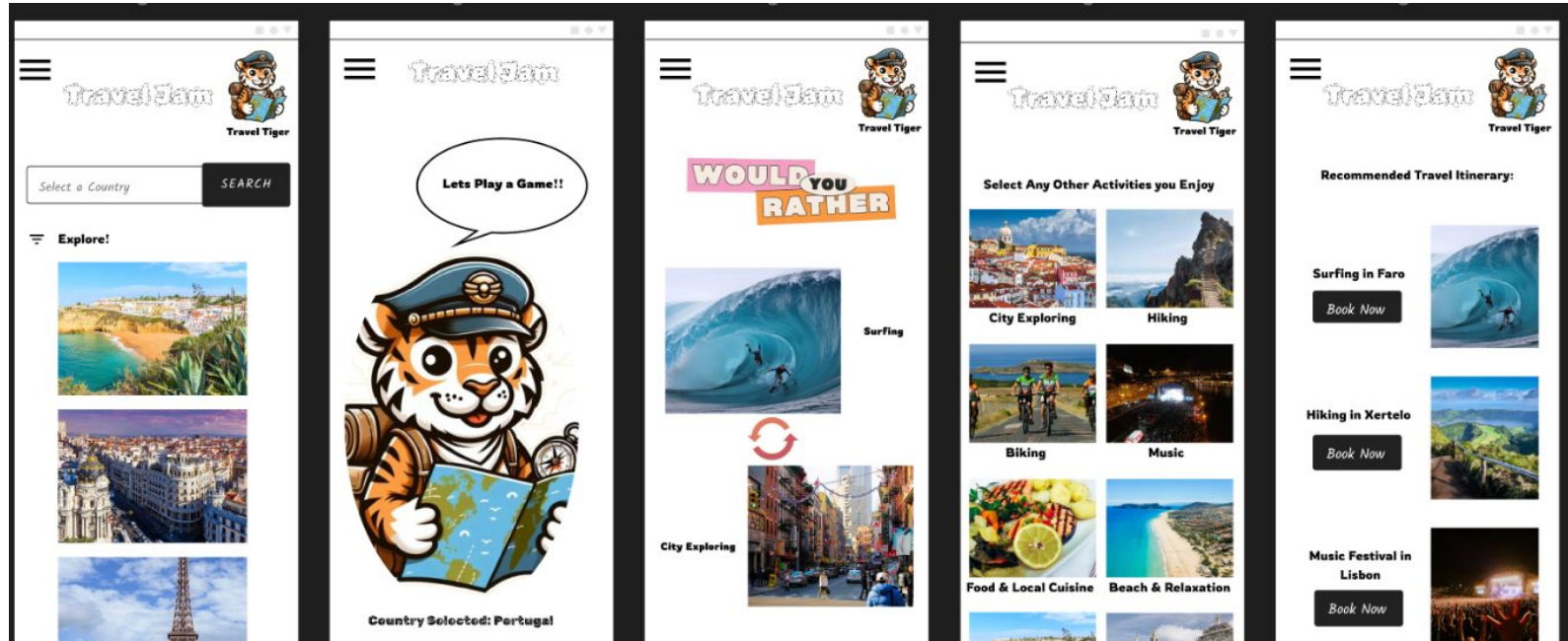
02 Brainstorming

Prototype 2: Textual Prototype

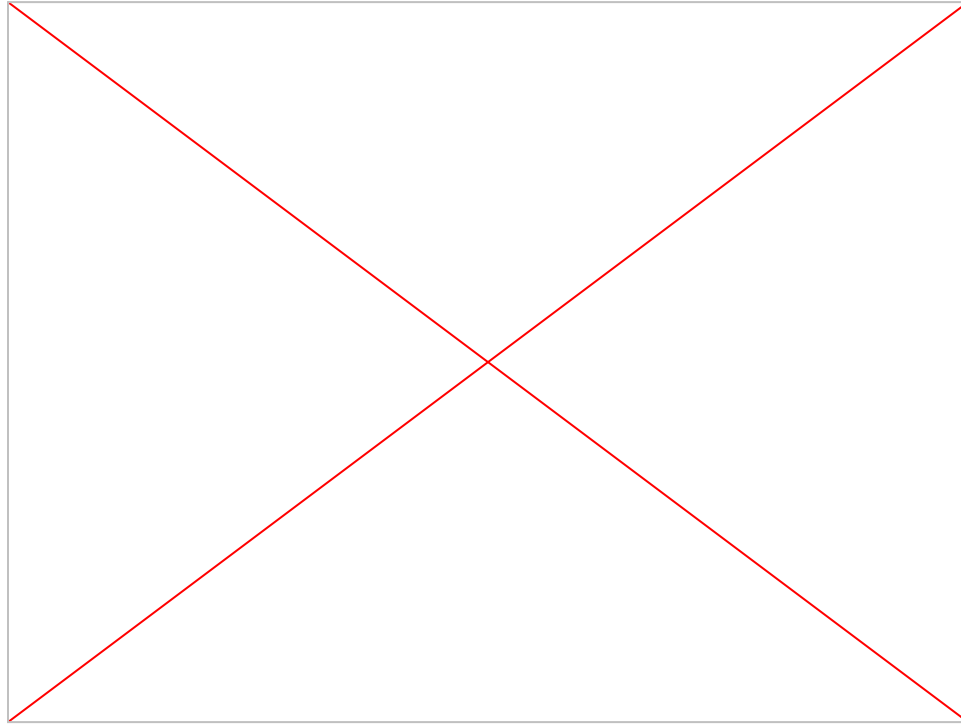
Our app will allow users to discover and explore travel options based on either the activity they want to do or place they are visiting. The resulting output will show users either the places corresponding to the activity they desire, or activity recommendations based on the place they want to visit. The Travel Jam app will then have a social-media based interface that allows users to scroll through multiple options and like the ones that interest them. From their liked activities or places, they can view them on their profile and add them to their trip. This implements the familiar pagination method of scrolling to view multiple options, and liking to store selected favorites. The posts and videos that can be viewed will include a small mix of sponsored content from hotels, travel attractions, and destinations, but mostly be creator original content, similar to tik tok.

02 Brainstorming

Prototype 3: Wireframe prototype



03 Prototype



04 Evaluation- Think Aloud

Introductions

Introduced the purpose and ourselves, asked preliminary questions



Instructions

Gave participant detailed instructions for activity



Observation

Used the app, and made sure to take notes

Questions

After they were done using most features, asked clarifying questions



Conclude

Post evaluation questions were asked to all participants



Analysis

Conducted detailed analysis and aggregated notes into data

04 Evaluation- Results

ADVANTAGE



Recognized the profile picture and location features quickly. Found the scrolling interface familiar once they understood it.



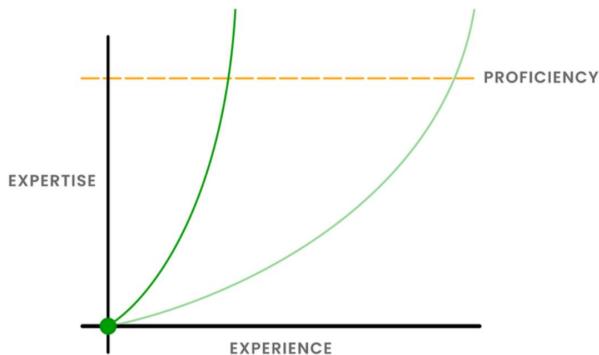
Found the scrolling interface intuitive once they started using it. Recognized the potential for inspiration from the videos similar to TikTok.



Eventually understood the scrolling interface and found it intuitive. Recognized familiar social media features like like, comment, and follow.



Found the app's scrolling interface very similar to TikTok and appreciated this familiarity. Liked the potential for addictive engagement due to the TikTok-like interface.



Due to the inspiration of Tiktok, the learning curve was steep. Participants had initial expertise due to their past experience with platforms such as Tiktok. The familiarity with other social media apps strengthened their mental model.

04 Evaluation- Results

DISADVANTAGE



Lack of discoverability: “Initial screen is confusing. I see all the buttons but I am unsure of what the options do and how to use them.”

Fix: Instructions for first time users describing how to use the app.



Lack of affordances: “I don’t know how to get to the feed. It’s not clear that I need to scroll. There is no indication that to see the next video I had to swipe up.”

Fix: Icon with hand swiping upwards to indicate scrolling on feed. More back buttons and buttons showing screens.



Lack of structure: “I was confused by the initial home page and hierarchy of options. There are flags, preferences, and itinerary but I am unsure of which to click first. I expected more context to explain the layout of the UI.”

Fix: Simplistic homepage that is not crowded and has more context to explain the options.

Reflection



Project Reflection

- Home screen could be more intuitive
- Buttons on app are confusing and could be more symbolic as to what their function is
- Join group function should be more developed



Project Development

- Mirror operations of other social media apps to give participants initial expertise.
- Design a less crowded, simplistic home page with a clear hierarchy of instructions
- Add more affordances to reduce mental load



THANKS FOR LISTENING!

DO YOU HAVE ANY QUESTIONS?